LAIZE FERRAZ

Frontend Software Engineer

Sunshine Coast, QLD | Australian Citizen
Mobile: (+61) 0478.593.071
Email: laizeferraz@gmail.com
LinkedIn | Portfolio | GitHub

Professional Summary

Frontend Software Engineer with **4+ years** of experience building user-centred web products, specialising in **React**, **TypeScript**, and JavaScript, including learning tools used by **200,000+ students**. A former coding instructor, I enjoy understanding the problem behind a requirement and turning complex needs into simple, intuitive experiences. I care about quality, accessibility, performance, and thoughtful component design, and I work closely with designers, engineers, and stakeholders to find practical solutions that serve both users and the business.

Main Skills: React | TypeScript | JavaScript | Next.js | HTML | CSS | Lit / Web Components | Material UI | Tailwind CSS | Vite | Storybook | Component-Driven Development | Vitest | Jest | Cypress | Accessibility Testing | REST APIs | CI/CD | Agile/Scrum

Professional Experience

Freelance | Frontend Software Engineer *Sep 2026 – Nov 2026* | *Sunshine Coast, QLD*

- Designed, built and launched a production website for **DanceFit Sunshine Coast**, a dance instructor's business, using **React**, **TypeScript**, Vite and CSS Modules, owning the project end-to-end from design to deployment.
- Set up **CI/CD** with Cloudflare Workers across separate development and production environments, and handled domain configuration and **SEO**, including Google Search Console setup and sitemap submission.
- Built to **WCAG 2 AA**, verified with Lighthouse audits and keyboard-only navigation testing.
- Optimised images and monitored **performance** with Chrome DevTools, WebPageTest and **Core Web Vitals**, achieving **Lighthouse scores of 95+ across all categories**.

Xestro | Software Engineer *Nov 2025 – Jan 2026* | *Sunshine Coast, QLD*

- Delivered frontend features for a healthcare SaaS platform using **React**, **TypeScript**, and JavaScript, working across modern and legacy areas of the product.
- Migrated existing JSX components to strongly typed TypeScript/TSX, supporting the team's transition to a more maintainable and type-safe frontend.
- Refactored React components using built-in and custom hooks, shared context, reusable helper functions, and separation of concerns, improving code maintainability, consistency, and reuse.
- Built and maintained responsive interfaces using **Material UI**, resolving layout and **usability** issues with close attention to accessibility and user experience.
- Conducted detailed **peer code reviews**, providing actionable feedback and implementation examples to improve code quality, maintainability, and knowledge sharing across the team.

Grok Academy | Software Engineer *Oct 2023 – Aug 2024* | *Sydney, NSW*

- Developed a reusable Web Component library using Lit and **TypeScript** for Grok Academy's learning platform—which reaches **200,000+ students across 3,400 Australian schools**—enabling educators to efficiently author interactive computing courses.
- **Partnered with educators** to shape each component they requested, running feedback sessions during development and incorporating their input to deliver intuitive, reusable solutions for real classroom content.
- Built **accessible**, reusable components including chat bubbles, feedback elements, and information blocks, ensuring consistent **UX** and alignment with Grok's visual identity.

- Created **Storybook** documentation and interactive examples for educators, and **proposed and built** tooling to automatically generate documentation from JSDoc, overcoming Storybook's limited Web Components support at the time and reducing manual documentation work.
- Achieved **100% unit test coverage** across the component library using Open Web Components Testing and **Vitest**, supporting reliable and maintainable educational experiences.
- Implemented **automated accessibility testing** and vision-impairment simulations in Storybook, helping ensure components could be used consistently and inclusively across learning content.

PALO IT | Software Engineer *Sep 2021 – Apr 2023* | *Sydney, NSW*

- Developed frontend features and user experiences across three client products using **React**, **TypeScript**, and **Next.js**, working within cross-functional Agile teams across implementation, testing, CI/CD, and delivery.
- **Promoted to Mid-level Software Engineer within one year**, recognising strong performance, technical growth, and contribution to client projects.
- Worked closely with in-house and external **designers** to translate designs into responsive, user-friendly interfaces.
- Collaborated with engineers and stakeholders in Scrum teams to clarify business requirements, evaluate implementation approaches, solve technical challenges, and deliver high-quality software.
- Presented technical concepts, implementation decisions, and product updates to technical and non-technical stakeholders during sprint reviews, and contributed to engineering quality through peer code reviews.
- Became the go-to person for **onboarding new team members** (junior to senior), drawing on my teaching background and deep project knowledge to help them ramp up quickly.

Selected Projects:

- **Cyber Insurance Platform:** Developed React interfaces for policy management and risk reporting, replacing Excel-based workflows, and maintained existing Cypress end-to-end tests by diagnosing and fixing failing test cases.
- **Digital Mental Health MVP:** Shipped 10 interactive therapy modules using Next.js, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS, enabling parents and psychologists to work together to help children overcome their fears.
- **White-Label NFT Marketplace:** Built reusable React components for fiat payment flows, supporting Stripe API integration and enabling buyers to purchase digital assets.

Academy Xi | Frontend Software Engineer Instructor *Sep 2020 – Jul 2021 & May 2022 – Aug 2022* | *Sydney, NSW*

- Taught and mentored **60+ aspiring web developers** in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and React, helping students develop practical frontend skills and prepare for careers in technology.
- Created coding exercises, assessments, presentations, and other learning resources to make complex frontend concepts easier to understand and apply.
- Provided individual mentoring, constructive feedback, and technical guidance, adapting explanations to different learning needs and supporting students through coding, problem-solving, and teamwork challenges.

Education & Credentials

- **Postgraduate in Full Stack Development:** Rocketseat (online) | In progress, expected 2028
- **Certificate IV in Web-based Technologies:** TAFE, Sydney, Australia | 2019
- **Bachelor of Law:** Tiradentes University, Brazil
- **Languages:** Portuguese (native), English (fluent)